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Wellington & District

LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Euchareena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

Established August, 2021
 THURSDAY, February 5, 2026
 ISSN 2653-2026

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Wellington Boot Carnival
 Friday 10 April
 Sunday 12 April

Call for Wellington crisis accommodation for DFV
 - P3
 Sign the petition

Letters to Editor
 Let's organise our own Australia Day - P2, 6.

Junior Touch Footy, U12 Cricket, Swim stars in photos - P17,18,19.



All's looking well on the course and greens for the centenary celebrations at Wellington Golf Club on Sunday, March 15. Golf course grounds manager Damien Bell checks the 18th green with James Smith and Peter Holden in readiness for the big family day.

Hundred years on the green

WELL, it won't be on the actual date - records talk of 1924, but according to an official document held at the current clubhouse, the Wellington Golf Club was formed in 1925 on "Nanima", the Barton family property, with an 18-hole sand-green course near the Macquarie Bridge between Nanima and the Macquarie River - but there's going to be a centenary celebration out at the present 'Caves' sight on Sunday, March 15.
 It's always great to have an excuse to hold a party, so Wellington Soldiers Memorial Golf Club is inviting all to participate in the day.
 It won't be all golf. The party has been arranged so that every member of your family will be entertained.
 An all-day barbecue will bee the hunger fangs at bay and there'll be plenty of fun things for the youngsters.
 Junior putting, just one of the golfing games for the kids.

Plenty of seating, inside and outdoors will be available for relaxing in or out of the sun.
 For those who are keen of golf, or those who just play once in a while, the club has organised a 'Four-Person Ambrose' competition to make it easier on the lesser experienced players.
 Make sure you form a team of one or two good players in the mix.
 There'll be plenty of prizes to share around as well.
 Team entries are now be called and will close closer to the day.
 Importantly, being a centenary celebration, people are being asked to make contact with past Wellingtonians, even if they were not club members, and encourage them to head to Wellington for the weekend.
 More information will be published as it comes to hand,

however, **turn to Page 15** to view some of the historic 'old' photos found in the club archives.



Wellington Division 1 Pennant Team 1996 - John Donnelly, Gary McCarthy, Gary Cusack, Gary Holding, Robert Baker and Darren Whiteley.

Inside this week

Stuart Town, Mumbil, Euchareena
 'Stumbileena' Australia Day awards - Page 4

We want to know why you haven’t used the Bulky Bin Service

COUNCIL IS encouraging those who haven’t used their pre-booked bulky rubbish collection service in the past year to tell us why.

A trial of the pre-booked bulky rubbish collection service was introduced on 1 July, 2024, with that trial is due to cease on 30 June 2026.

Councillors will now review feedback from the community and the council staff before making a decision whether to stay with the pre-booked system, or to return to the general kerbside cleanup.

Under the pre-booked collection trial, eligible households were able to book one collection per financial year, at a time that suited them.

Before that, the system operated on a fixed schedule, with an annual zone-based system running from October to December across the LGA.

The pre-booked model costs approximately \$383,000 annually, compared to the former annual pick-up which costed approximately \$527,000.

Around 21,500 residences are eligible for the service, with over 2000 bookings made

in the first half of the 2025/2026 financial year. In the 2024/2025 financial year, 2990 bookings were made for the service.

A report will go back to Council this year to determine the future of the service, and as Councillors we want to make an informed decision, which includes feedback from those who have and haven’t used the service. The non-user survey is now open, and will run until 10 March 2026.

Non-users of the collection can access the survey on Council’s Your Say page at <https://yoursay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/bulky-rubbish-collection-survey>

Applications open for Community Funding Program:

Applications are now open for Council’s Community Funding Program, which streamlines our grant and funding opportunities.

Applications must be submitted via Smarty Grants by 5pm Saturday 28 February to be considered for the second assessment period.

For more information visit: www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/funding

Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund

Applications have opened for the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund.

The benefit fund is open only to community groups in the Wellington district to support projects that provide a direct benefit to local communities in the area.

There is \$68,279.56 available for Round 11 of the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund.

Grant programs like the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund play an important role in helping our community groups access the financial support they need to secure resources, deliver services, and run programs that strengthen and enrich our community.

Applications are now open and close on Saturday 28 February 2026.

Applications must be made via Smarty-Grants and will not be accepted via paper or email.

Eligible applications will be reviewed by an internal panel and considered by Councillors at a future meeting of Council.

For further information visit

www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/funding

Dubbo Region Cultural Council - Express your interest!

We’re seeking six community members to join the Dubbo Region Cultural Council.

Community members are encouraged to apply if they can reflect and represent the following stakeholder areas.

* Social Services Community Representatives (two reps)

This may include stakeholders from health services, community services, culturally and linguistically diverse communities, disability and aged services, and youth services.

* Regional Creative Practitioners (four reps)

This may include stakeholders from creative, cultural, or heritage organisations; independent creative practitioners; and event or program managers.

Express your interest by 9am on Wednesday 4 March 2026 at <https://yoursay.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/cultural-council-eoi>

Josh Black

Letters to Editor

Editor,

SO PLEASED to read commonsense in the paper today (WDL 290126).

Saturday must have been so hot. Enjoying a bacon and egg roll at that time wouldn’t be nice. I hope Dubbo have realised their mistake now. Please go back to the 26th January at 9am onwards for event.

Our town can do it on our own and especially our seniors will return.

Here’s hoping.

Dorothy Blake

The Editor,

Re: Opinion 29-1-26.

AUSTRALIA DAY as celebrated by Dubbo Regional Council (DRC) style does not work.

Their approach is cold and not encompassing all the peoples in the old Wellington Council area.

The writing is on the wall when you see Mumbil, Stuart Town and Euchareena organising their own

committees to organise their own Australia Day celebrations.

I believe we should have a Wellington community committee to organise Australia Day celebrations for the Wellington area with our own Ambassador.

With some support from one of the many environmental developments here now to help with some finances.

I was on the previous Wellington Australia Day Committee for nearly 30 years and seeing how it was organised and run leaves the current situation heartless.

Dubbo wanted it on their day (not Australia Day) at their time in the heat of the day, run completely by Councillors not by an Australia Day Committee.

The previous Wellington Day Committee had a democratically elected Chairman (K.J. Mason the last one) and committee with reps from Stuart Town, Geurie and different Nationalities in the Council area.

In relation to different communities, they were included in events such as Dancers from the aboriginals, also Singers from the same group.

We had flags from other Countries paraded to show how Wellington welcomed everyone and, on another occasion, local food from other nations welcomed. Wellington started the day at 7.30am, the coolest part of the day to allow people from as far away as Kerrs Creek to be welcomed to the event.

Before it is too late, start organising our own Australia Day celebrations.

It will be a long haul to overcome how the previous group was treated by Dubbo but we can do it.

Peter Sheridan OAM

The Editor,

I and many others agree with the ‘Opinion’ printed in last week’s Leader.

Most of us are too busy or lazy to write – or maybe we think someone else will do it.

The points made are very correct, when we first came to Wellington the Australia Day event was on in the morning and it was very pleasant sitting in Cameron Park listening to and witnessing all the chosen community minded people in Wellington being acknowledged, watching the Guides raise the flags and the Town Band perform.

Not so in the last few years! Hot sun! Hot Air! Particularly this year when all the news outlets were telling people to stay out of the sun and stay in airconditioned buildings.

If it must be held in the afternoon why not in the Council’s airconditioned Civic Centre – which doesn’t appear to be used much!

Australia Day is the 26th January, as it appears that while people were considered Australian it wasn’t until the Nationality & Citizenship Act which took effect on 26th January 1949 came into effect that formally created the legal status

of an ‘Australian Citizen’, that should be the day and reason we celebrate!

Not the other reasons people think we should or shouldn’t celebrate for.

Name withheld at writer’s request

The price of a “Leader” is only half the cost of a coffee

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O’Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

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Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

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Funeral Notice

Robert “BRUCE” Crockett
Aged 95 years
Late of Orange, formally Bakers Swamp

Adored Husband of Beryl (dec)
Loved father to Rodney,
Malcolm & Judith (father in law)
Cherished Grandfather to Rachel and James

Adored Great Grandfather to Anastasia, Isabella and Christopher
Dear friend to Marie

Relatives and friends are warmly invited to attend Bruces's funeral service, to be held at

St John the Baptist Anglican Church Wellington

on Thursday 5th February 2026, Commencing at 10.30am

Followed by a private cremation

H Logue & Sons Funerals, Wellington NSW 0268451946

Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed for publication in the Wellington & District Leader

Contact: mark@wdleader.news

Urgent call for crisis accommodation in Wellington to keep women and children safe and connected

WELLINGTON FAMILY and Domestic Violence Collective (WFDVC) in partnership with the Association of Children's Welfare Agencies (ACWA) is calling for urgent investment in local crisis accommodation so women, children and families experiencing domestic and family violence (DFV) can remain safe without being forced to leave their community.

Wellington is one of many regional communities across NSW where there is no dedicated crisis accommodation for people escaping DFV.

As a result, families are often forced to relocate far from their cultural connections, schools, extended family and support networks. This displacement increases trauma and instability for children, who are already living with the impacts of violence.

ACWA's Director of Family Preservation and Safety, Carolyn Thompson, said the lack of local options leaves families at risk.

"We have spoken to Wellington women who have been impacted by DFV and the need is clear," she said.

"Women and children deserve emergency accommodation in their own community where they can stay connected to family, culture and support.

No one should have to choose between safety and staying in the place they call home."

Data from the NSW Bureau of Crime Statistic and Research (BOCSAR) shows that rates of DV related assault per capita are higher in rural and remote areas.

In Wellington these assaults occurred at 3.7 times the state average between July 2024 and June 2025.

At a statewide level, around 2500 DV incidents are reported to police every month, with underreporting meaning the true number is far higher.

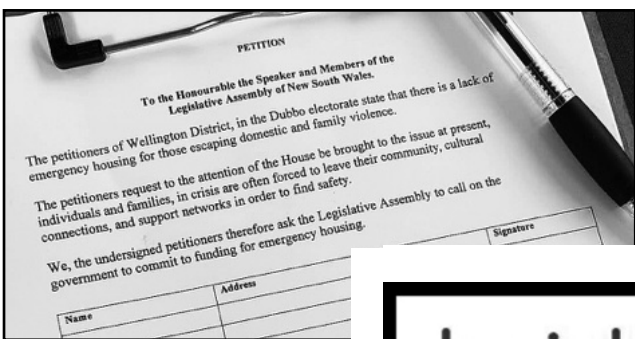
WFDVC chairperson, Grant Connolly, said the absence of crisis accommodation places families in unacceptable danger.

"Families in Wellington deserve better than this. Access to safe crisis accommodation within the community should be a basic human right. Without it, we are putting women and children at risk every day," Mr Connolly said.

The Need

The partnership between WFDVC and ACWA calls for:

- Capital and operating funding for crisis accommodation in Wellington.
- A community led model that supports cultural connection, stability and safety.
- Collaboration between Homes NSW, DCJ, and local services to



design a fit for purpose solution.

- Integrated supports that link housing, family services and violence prevention.

A community wide call to action

This partnership urges all levels of government, local services, private enterprise and the broader Wellington community to work together to deliver safe local crisis accommodation.

Women, children and families should not have to leave their community to find safety.

People are being asked to sign the petition to call the government to action.

The partnership is lobbying the State Government for emergency housing for DV victims in the Wellington area.

You can find copies of the petition at Wellington Aboriginal Corporation Health Service, Ben's Tyres, The Duck Stop, Monkey On The Wire and Jespresso Coffee Co.



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NOW OPEN BODANGORA WIND FARM COMMUNITY BENEFIT FUND

Community groups are encouraged to apply for funding through the Bodangora Wind Farm Community Benefit Fund.

Applications close on Saturday 28 February 2026. Applications must be made via SmartyGrants and will not be accepted via paper or email.

Scan the QR code for more information or visit dubbo.nsw.gov.au/funding



Stumbileena Australia Day at Stuart Town

RESIDENTS WITHIN the communities of Mumbil, Stuart Town and Euchareena (Stumbileena) have finally let all know that they want Australia Day celebrated on the ‘day’ January 26. After the Dubbo-based regional council resolved to hold the ‘day’ on Australia Day eve, the districts put up with it until this year. When council decided to stick with the eve ceremony in Wellington, then changed the date for Dubbo, Stumbileena – (Stuart Town, Mumbil, Euchareena) walked away from the council’s plans and decided to hold their own – on the actual day. And after Wellington’s scorching hot ceremony on the ‘eve’, Wellington locals are up in arms because council has taken over the ceremony with little or minimal involvement of Wellington district communities.

With Australia Day Council’s full support, the Stuart Town Advancement Association conducted the Stumbileena awards on the actual Australia Day at Moxon Park from 8am with the awards ceremony starting at 8.45am.

The Stumbileena Village citizens of the Year were Sheree and Jamie Howard, who returned to the town several years ago and restored and re-opened the Stuart Town Store, much to the delight of the district, and in the past 12 months bought the local hotel, and now Stuart Town is humming, thanks to the community mindedness of Jamie and Sheree.

Euchareena Citizen of the year was Peter Wykes, well respected voice for the area and strong long-time rural fire service veteran area Captain.

Mumbil Citizen was Hazel Keogh, certainly the major stalwart of the town. Young Citizen of the year was Gracie Pulbrook.



Stumbileena Australia Day awardees and guests about to cut their Australia Day cake at Stuart Town’s Moxon Park.



Village Citizens of the Year "Stumbileena" Jamie Howard and Sheree Robertson with deputy mayor Phillip Toynton, Lukas Butler and mayor Josh Black who attended.



Community Encouragement awards to Abbeylea Marlin, Tobey Robertson and Andrew Broadbent.



Addison Hanney led the 100-head gathering singing Advance Australia Fair.



RFS Member of the Year awarded to Craig Gurney.



Young Citizen of the Year is Gracie Pulbrook.



Community Achievement award to Sam McGregor.



Euchareena Citizen of the Year is Peter Wykes.



Mumbil Citizen of the Year is Hazel Keogh.



Community Achievement award to Ted Montgomery.



Community Achievement award to Barbara Eade.



Community Achievement award to Mel Howard.

NSW Rugby Juniors congratulates Ben Gregory OAM

NSW RUGBY Juniors is proud to congratulate Ben Gregory OAM on being awarded the Medal of the Order of Australia in recognition of his outstanding service to rugby union and his lifelong contribution to junior rugby across New South Wales.

Ben's connection to the game spans more than four decades and reflects a deep commitment to community volunteerism and the development of young people through rugby.

His journey began as a junior player with Wellington NSW in the early 1980s followed by school rugby at Shore and senior rugby with Wellington Seniors and Woolahra Colleagues before finishing his playing career with the Hunters Hill Rugby Cats.

It was through Hunters Hill Juniors that Ben became deeply immersed in rugby administration serving more than 14 years on the committee including three years as Juniors President.

His leadership care for volunteers and dedication to creating positive experiences for young players have left a lasting impact on the club.

Ben remains actively involved and in 2026 will officiate his 25th Hunters Hill Dufficy Cup at Boronia Park a remarkable milestone that speaks to his enduring commitment.

Ben's influence extended well beyond club rugby.

Through leadership roles with

Sydney Junior Rugby Union and NSW Rugby Juniors including five years as President he played a key role in shaping junior rugby pathways across NSW Country Sydney Juniors and NSW Schools.

His work has helped strengthen participation governance and opportunity for thousands of junior players coaches and volunteers across the state.

Ben has also contributed to the broader game through roles with NSW Rugby and the NSW Waratahs always championing the importance of strong grassroots foundations.

His service has previously been recognised through Life Memberships with Hunters Hill Rugby 2014 Sydney Junior Rugby Union 2020 and NSW Rugby Juniors 2022.

The awarding of the Medal of the Order of Australia is a fitting acknowledgement of Ben's integrity generosity and unwavering dedication to junior rugby.

NSW Rugby Juniors warmly congratulates Ben Gregory on this well-deserved honour and thanks him for the legacy he continues to build within our rugby community.

Early days

Former Wellington Redbacks Rugby Club Player (Juniors and Seniors) Best & Fairest Wellington Rugby 3rd Grade 1991 Wellington Public School Alumni (1983).



Visit the Centre every Sunday 1pm-4pm
Seniors Tai Chi every Friday 9:30am
Restorative Yoga - Sun 15 Feb 9am-10:30am
Tibetan New Year Puja Sun 22 Feb 11:30am

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**A copy of a "Leader" is
half the price of a coffee**



Hydrostor Invites You to a Community Information Session

Hydrostor is proposing an advanced compressed air energy storage (A-CAES) project in Wellington, NSW. The Project will be able to power millions of homes for 16 hours, providing key reliability to the grid as it continues to incorporate renewables to meet Australia's decarbonization goals. Hydrostor is hosting its first community drop-in sessions so community members can learn about the proposed Project and provide feedback.

Wellington Sessions
Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club
75 Arthur Street
Wellington

Thursday 12 February 2026
11:30am-1:30pm & 6pm-8pm

Dubbo Session
Dubbo Cultural Centre
76 Wingewarra Street
Dubbo

Saturday 14 February 2026
11am-1pm

As the proposed Project develops, we will continue to keep communities informed and seek opportunities for interested stakeholders and community members to provide input and feedback.



Find out more:
www.research.net/r/wellington_acaes



Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area

- ✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purpose built wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House



✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge

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Authorised by Andrew Gee, MP, Suite 1/179A Anson Street, Orange NSW 2800

Letter to the editor

The Editor,
I READ your ‘Opinion’ column with great interest.
As you know I served on the Australia Day Committee for three years up until this year.
This year I was told that they (Dubbo Regional Council) were doing things differently, that is, they were asking last year’s awardees to be on the committee.
I thought fair enough. But, then on Sunday I was told that only one person from last year and one person from the previous year were on the committee.
I found this very interesting, as not

everyone wants to be on committees.
I feel something as important as Australia Day awards needs people who are keen and dedicated to carry out such important decisions.
The first year I was on the Committee, DRC representatives told us, this is your day, tell us what you want.
Last year, DRC representatives took over the committee and told us what was happening.
I agree that it is time Wellington is in charge of their own Australia Day ceremony, and maybe then only with guidance from DRC.
Jennifer Wykes

Rabbit virus plan struck down

From ABC Western Plains Radio
A PLANNED release of a virus aimed at eliminating rabbits around Mudgee has been abandoned due to rabbit immunity.
Mid-Western Regional Council says it will shift to alternative methods to control urban rabbit populations after tests revealed local rabbits have developed resistance to the deadly Calicivirus.
The council had planned to release

the virus next month as part of its wild rabbit control program.
Instead, it said it would take an integrated, community wide approach supported by a rabbit control workshop next month to provide practical advice on eradication, warren destruction and preventing reinfestation. Pet rabbit owners are also being reminded to ensure vaccinations are up to date, with council to confirm workshop details soon.

Foreign drivers licence reform update

THE STATE government is reforming licensing loopholes and strengthening foreign licence conversion arrangements to help keep NSW roads safe.
As part of its commitment to pull every lever to improve road safety, the government is tightening licence conversion rules to ensure drivers and riders on the state’s roads meet high safety standards.
From last Sunday a further group of overseas drivers and riders aged 25 years and over from a broader selection of countries will now be required to pass a knowledge test and a driving test before converting their overseas licence to a NSW licence.
The changes close long-standing inconsistencies that allowed drivers from ‘List B’ countries and jurisdictions to obtain a NSW licence without

this testing.
Drivers under 25 from ‘List B’ countries are already required to pass knowledge and driving tests, and that requirement will remain unchanged.
The reform builds on earlier action requiring long-term residents to convert overseas licences within six months of moving to NSW, and brings NSW in line with other states and territories, ensuring consistent national standards.
To support the changes, Service NSW is boosting testing capacity, temporarily increasing availability with up to 320 extra driving test slots every Saturday, which has become effective from January 31.
Online bookings are updated weekly, and customers are encouraged to plan ahead and regularly check availability online.

Did you know 82% of people say PRINT ADS are STILL the most trusted form of advertising for making purchasing decisions.

Great Western Highway ‘White Paper’ – a major fail by NSW Government

I’M EXTREMELY disappointed with the NSW Government’s White Paper on the Great Western Highway, which has killed off any upgrade to this critical link between the city and the bush.
The dream of a tunnel is now dead and buried. This adds insult to injury after decades of government inaction on the long-promised expressway to Sydney over the Blue Mountains.
In 2007, the National Party turned the first sod on the Bells Line of Road expressway. This kicked off a golden age of broken promises, delays and funding raids that all the major parties are guilty of.
The expressway was abandoned by the National Party when city people objected. So much for standing up for the bush!
When they had the chance to build it, they squibbed it - 12 years in power in New South Wales, nine years in power federally, and nothing’s ever been built.
Then, when it came to power, the current Federal Labor government grabbed \$2 billion that the previous Coalition Government had allocated, and we never saw it again.

Not one of these major parties has any vision for an expressway to Sydney - not one.
While the major parties dither, the traffic jams from the Central West to Sydney are worse than ever. Country people deserve better than this.
The White Paper is just the latest heart breaker. It doesn’t acknowledge how vital this link is to the people of the Central West for work, health and lifestyle. It offers no major initiatives to cut travel times between Sydney and our region.
This report is a blueprint for walking away from a genuine expressway to Sydney, and because it’s so disappointingly unambitious, it takes the pressure off the Federal Government to do anything either.
How is it that we can have expressways built all over the state except out here?
At one stage we were paying \$53 million per kilometre to build the Pacific Highway. We would have loved to have seen a fraction of that money.
Yet despite making such a massive contribution to the wealth of this state and nation, all we get out here is cheap talk and spare change.
What a joke – no wonder people are turning away from the major parties. I’ll be keeping the pressure on in Parliament this year.

Well-deserved gong for Griggys

Your Citizen of the Year doesn’t like to blow his own trumpet, so I’ll play a Reveille for him on this page!
Griggys is a bloody good bloke and a stalwart of



the Wellington community.
He says he went to the School of Hard Knocks and followed up at the University of Life – a comprehensive and wholesome education.
For decades, Mark has been passionately entrenched in Wello’s web of social and economic development, such as Council and Mayor, the Business Enterprise Centre, Chamber of Commerce, PCYC and local clubs.
But I want to give him a special shoutout for his incredible contribution to local media, which is integral to our community cohesion.
Mark is one of the founding members and present Chairperson of Binjang Community Radio Inc – not to forget, a memorable voice on the Break-fast Show.
More than four years ago, when retirement wasn’t an option, Griggys and his wife Sharon took up the mantle to give Wellington it’s local voice through this mighty publication.
Newspapers have run through Griggys’s blood since he was a lad, and I want to thank him and Sharon for their unwavering commitment to publishing the Wellington and District Leader.
As rural media continues to disappear, replaced by mass content produced by major mastheads, it’s vital we acknowledge the hard work and dedication of our independent publishers across the Central West.



with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld



BACK IN July 2002, I found myself on my first trip to the United States.
I was there to collect an award at the annual Microsoft Worldwide Partner Conference - a big deal for a young Australian business owner.
I spent time on both the west coast and the east coast and discovered a first world problem with a very clunky solution: I had to hire three different mobile phones just to stay connected back home.
At the time, the US mobile market was a patchwork quilt of competing standards. One phone worked in one city, another worked somewhere else, and none of them spoke nicely to each other.
Competition might have been great for prices, but it was terrible for interoperability. The idea of taking my Australian mobile phone to the US and roaming was genuinely laughable.
Fast forward to today, and I’m writing this from Sri Lanka, happily using my mobile phone to make calls, send messages and access the internet with very little fuss.
6 THURSDAY, February 5, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

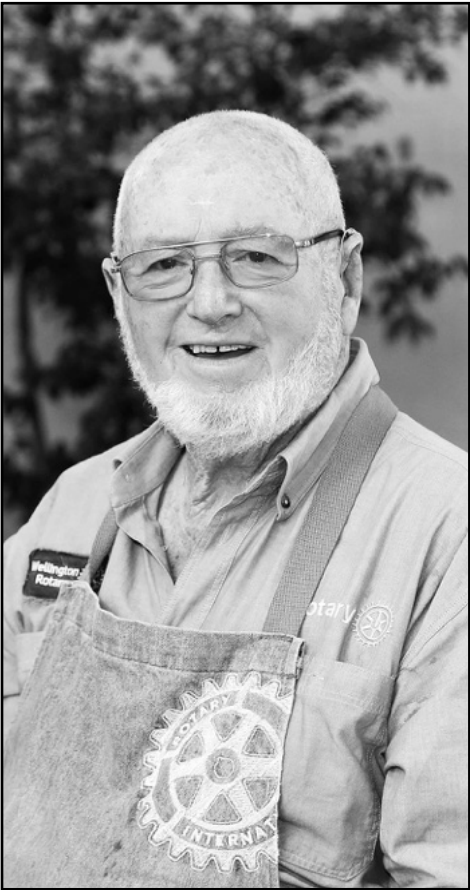
It was 1987 when European governments and telecom authorities agreed to create one single digital mobile phone standard, called GSM, but the reality was it was around 2009 when the world genuinely agreed on 4G LTE. It changed travel and also how connected the planet feels.
What’s fascinating is how rare that kind of global agreement actually is.
Take driving, for example. Imagine if we all agreed to drive on one side of the road. Car manufacturing would be more efficient, more models would be available globally, and costs might even come down.
But then imagine the chaos - and the road toll - if half the world had to switch overnight.
Then there’s electricity. Homes in countries like Australia, the UK and much of Europe run on 220 to 240 volts. The US, Canada and parts of Japan use 110 to 120 volts. We’ve never agreed on a single standard, but clever engineering has stepped in to smooth things over.
Most modern devices can quietly handle

different voltages without us giving it a second thought, although the different plugs are still frustrating.
There are other everyday examples of varying agreement. USB charging cables are now standardising on USB-C, thanks largely to the European Union.
Paper sizes differ - A4 versus Letter - but printers cope. Shoe sizes nominate which sizing is applicable to which standard.
We can agree just enough to function, but rarely enough to simplify everything.
Mobile phones, however, are a rare success story. Today’s smartphones can jump among networks, frequencies and countries with impressive ease. Whether you’re in Sydney, San Francisco or Colombo, your phone knows how to behave.
So, here’s the question travellers keep asking: if the technology is standardised, why does roaming still cost so much?
The short answer is that roaming isn’t really a technical problem anymore - it’s a commercial one.
When you roam, your home provider is

essentially renting access from a foreign network and passing that cost on to you, typically with a significant margin. The fees are the result of complex agreements between telcos, not a limitation of the technology itself.
The good news is that this is slowly changing. Competition from travel eSIMs, local data plans and consumer pressure is forcing prices down. The trend is clear: seamless global connectivity is becoming an expectation, not a luxury.
Today, we argue about roaming charges while streaming video from the other side of the planet. And it does make you wonder: if we can agree on how billions of phones talk to each other, what else might we eventually sort out? Language?

I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first ten e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, get involved, get a freebie!

Snapped at the 2026 Wellington Australia Day ceremony



Gallangabang to conduct its annual general meeting

Gallangabang Aboriginal Corporation (GAC) was set up in 2009 by agreement of the Wellington Aboriginal community. GAC represents 14 Wellington Traditional Aboriginal families.

Among its valued objectives are: to respect the cultural diversity of our members and value their contribution; to respect Elders and value their knowledge and encourage the heritage and cultural values that strengthen the environment in which we live; and, to promote Aboriginal cultural restoration and education.

GAC promoted these objectives last year by managing country, participating in various archaeological surveys on country to protect Aboriginal Cultural Heritage sites on various energy development projects.

Directors of GAC are volunteers seeking to protect and promote Aboriginal cultural heritage in Wellington.

Members are welcome to attend the AGM to be held on at 11am on Saturday, February 28, 2026 at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club. **See advertisement Page 8**

Lions back in action for the year

WELLINGTON LIONS hope everyone had a Merry Christmas and will have a good New Year.

Lions would like to thank everyone who donated their good quality Books, Cds, Jig-saw puzzles or Dvds over the past months to the Preloved Book shop. And of course, everyone who comes in and buys something.

Every child who visits the shop with an adult receives a free children's book.

The shop is normally open Thursday to Saturday 10am to 2pm in the historic Kimbell's Kitchen building, but due to the very hot weather experienced this past week closed at 1pm, and hope no-one was inconvenienced.

The club's first meeting this year is at 6pm on Monday, February 9. Wellington Lions in common with other clubs would love to see new members and all are welcome to come and meet club members and see what goes on.

The meetings are in the Alfresco room at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 6pm second and fourth Mondays of the month starting at 6pm, some members stay for dinner afterwards.

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 Australian Government

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Positions Vacant



BAR STAFF

Immediate Start

Must have Experience
and possess current
RSA and RGC

CONTACT: General Manager,
Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club
stephen@wellingtonsoldiers.com
phn: 0400 604 580

Public Notice

NOTICE OF AGM

GALLANGABANG ABORIGINAL CORPORATION

PLACE: WELLINGTON SOLDIERS MEMORIAL CLUB

TIME: 10.30AM

DATE: SATURDAY 28 FEBRUARY 2026

ALL MEMBERS INVITED

Check out our new website



Wellington & District Leader

Positions Vacant



We have a new position available for an
ADMINISTRATION ASSISTANT

This position would suit a young person,
maybe straight from high school,
looking to establish a career in
registered club administration.

Needs to be: Punctual, well presented, have
typing skills and willing to participate in a
TAFE Administration course.

Must hold an RSA and RGC or willing
to obtain both.

CONTACT: General Manager,
Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club
stephen@wellingtonsoldiers.com

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries

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Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

Sports reports

Your sport can record results in the “Sport” section.

Just contact:

mark@wdleader.news

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering

MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
6pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Riverside Church Inc.
170 Thornton Street
Sunday: 10.00am Service
Thursday: Bible Study for Men and Women 10.30 am

Everyone looks at the classifieds.

Promote your

Annual General Meetings, Social Club Events,

Birthday Parties

Homes and Flats to rent or wanted to rent

Lost and Found

Garage Sale

Memorium

Public Notice

Raffle prize winners

We’ll fit any size
Phone
0407 935 998

Around the electorate

with our State Member Dugald Saunders

Parliament resumes
PARLIAMENT HAS officially kicked off again for 2026!
No two weeks are ever the same, but one of the highlights of each sitting week for me is being able to recognise people or organisations from across the Dubbo electorate through Community Recognition Statements. Community Recognition Statements are an opportunity for Members of Parliament to acknowledge outstanding achievements or express words of thanks or condolence in Hansard - the official parliamentary record.
I do my best to keep across what is happening in the region, but I would love your help to make sure credit is given when it’s due.
If you know of someone, or a group of people, who are kicking goals and deserve a shoutout, please contact my office with their details and an overview of what they should be recognised for. Our region is home to some pretty incredible people; help me make sure their efforts don’t go un-noticed!

8 THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

ACEREZ Community Grants
The first round of the ACEREZ Community Grants Program is expected to open to applications in March.
Small grants between \$3000 to \$50,000 and significant grants between \$50,000 to \$1 million will be available to support projects that focus on public amenity, agriculture, education, health, sports and Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities. Eligible applicants in the Dubbo Regional Council and Mid-Western Regional Council areas are invited to attend an information session to get an overview of the program.
* Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club – Tuesday 17 February, 5pm-7pm
To register for an information session or learn more, visit
<https://www.acerez.com.au/community>, email cwo.community@acerez-acjv.com.au or call the ACEREZ community information line on 1800 298 379.

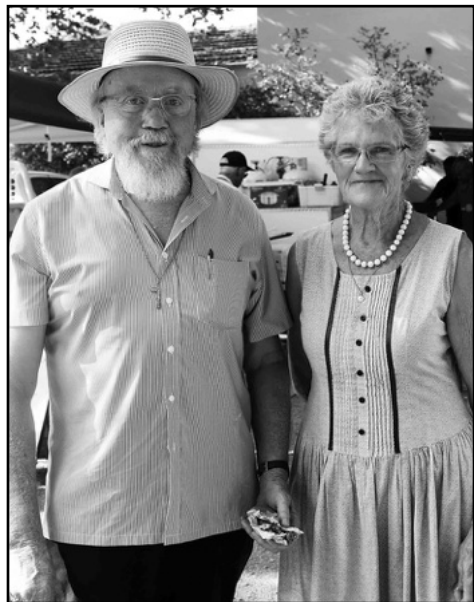
Holiday break funding
Applications are now open for the Holiday

Break Program Autumn/Winter 2026!
Eligible organisations can apply for \$1500–\$10,000, which can be split across the autumn and/or winter school holidays, to deliver high quality, fun and engaging holiday activities for young people aged 12-24.
The last round saw summer holiday programs delivered in the Dubbo electorate by Leaderlife, Narromine Skills Project, Narromine Shire Council, Orana Support Service and the NSW-Central West Muslims Association.
Applications for the autumn/winter round close at 11.59pm, Sunday 15 February 2026.
For more, visit:
<https://www.nsw.gov.au/living-nsw/young-people/about/holiday-break>
Summer safety: Heat first aid
You might have heard of the cold-related illness Hypothermia, but do you know about its heat-related illness counterpart, Hyperthermia?
February 4 was Extreme Heat Awareness Day, and this year the Australian Red Cross is encouraging everyone to learn the signs

and first aid tools so they can be prepared.
The signs of Hyperthermia include an inability to continue activity, poor muscle control or weakness; high body temperature; feeling faint or dizzy; nausea, vomiting or diarrhoea; pale or dry skin; and, altered behaviour or seizures.
If you or someone you know is displaying these symptoms, be prepared to call 000.
You can help alleviate the symptoms by monitoring responsiveness continually; lying down in a cool environment; loosening or removing excessive clothing; cooling the whole body down in the bath or shower for 15 minutes; placing icepacks on the groin, arm pits, cheeks, palms and soles of feet; fanning continuously; and, sipping water or an electrolyte drink
The risk for Hyperthermia is increased for young children and elderly, and in those who are pregnant, taking certain medications, and/or living with some medical conditions. If this applies to you or someone you know, please take extra care and precautions to stay safe this summer.

Until next time, Dugald

More Wellington Australia Day ceremony snaps



medicare

Now more people benefit from cheaper medicine



From January 1st 2026

Anyone with a Medicare card pays a maximum of \$25 for PBS listed medicines, down from \$31.60.

Concession card holders will continue to pay no more than \$7.70 until 2030.

For more information visit



health.gov.au/cheapermedicines

PBS



Australian Government

Authorised by the Australian Government, Canberra

TV

6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Bergerac. 1.45 Way Out Ag. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 3.00 Would I Lie To You? 3.30 Anh's Brush With Fame. 4.00 Love Your Garden. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Grand Designs Transformations. 9.00 Amanda & Alan's Italian Job. 9.30 The Piano UK. 10.20 Rural Flavours. 10.35 ABC Late News. 10.50 The Business. 11.05 Love Your Garden. 11.55 Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 South Aussie With Cosi. 2.30 House Calls To The Rescue. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Father Brown. 8.30 The Inspector Lynley Mysteries. 10.30 Murdoch Mysteries. 11.30 Late Programs.

Entertains

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.05 ER. 2.50 Heartbreak High. 3.40 Would I Lie To You? 4.10 MythBusters. 5.00 Car S.O.S. 5.45 Portrait Artist Of The Year. Return. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Hard Quiz. 9.00 Gruen. 9.40 Late Programs.

7

6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Catch Phrase. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Home And Away. 8.30 MOVIE: The Proposal. (2009) 10.50 To Be Advised. 12.35 Dare Me. New. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 The Force: Behind The Line. 3.30 Tougher In Alaska. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 More Power. 8.30 MOVIE: Green Zone. (2010) Matt Damon. 10.50 MOVIE: Resident Evil: The Final Chapter. (2016) 1.00 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 5.40 Kangaroo Beach. 6.05 PJ Masks Power Heroes. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago. 8.00 Deadly 60. 8.35 Secrets Of The Zoo. 9.20 The Secret Life Of Our Pets. 10.10 The Wonderful World Of Puppies. 10.55 Late Programs.

9

6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Married At First Sight. 1.45 9Honey Hacks. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Married At First Sight. 9.05 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Coverage includes curling and ice hockey. 12.00 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Post Midnight. 3.00 Late Programs.

flixx

6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Dream Home. 12.00 Dance Boss. 2.30 Gold Coast Ocean Rescue. 3.00 Toddlers Make You Laugh Out Loud. 4.00 Lopez Vs. Lopez. 4.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. 9.30 Ramsay's 24 Hours To Hell And Back. 10.30 Ramsay's Hotel Hell. 11.30 Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Parliament. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Late Programs.

10

6.00 Morning Programs. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.30 I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! 12.00 Farm To Fork. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Attenborough's Parenthood. 8.40 The Graham Norton Show. 9.50 10's Late News. 10.50 10 News+. 11.20 Stephen Colbert. 12.30 Late Programs.

drama

6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Reel Action. 9.00 The Living Room. 10.00 JAG. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 A Million Little Things. 2.30 JAG. 4.30 The Living Room. 5.30 JAG. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 FBI: International. 11.15 A Million Little Things. 12.15 Home Shopping.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Midsomer Murders. 3.00 Keeping Up Appearances. 4.00 MOVIE: Escapement. (1958) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 M*A*S*H. 8.00 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Night. 9.05 MOVIE: You've Got Mail. (1998) Tom Hanks, Meg Ryan. 11.30 Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 South America With Simon Reeve. 3.05 Going Places. 3.35 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.05 Secrets Of The Sabre-Toothed Tiger. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Toronto Airport Uncovered. 8.25 Robson Green: World's Most Amazing Walks. 9.20 In Flight. 10.15 SBS World News Late. 10.45 Before We Die. 11.40 This Town. 2.00 Because We Have Each Other. 3.30 Late Programs.

comedy

6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.45 Insight. 3.50 WorldWatch. 5.50 The Fast History Of. 6.40 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 MOVIE: Snatch. (2000) Benicio Del Toro. 10.30 The UnXplained With William Shatner. 11.20 Homicide: Life On The Street. 1.10 Threesome. 2.05 Late Programs.

TV

6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Muster Dogs. 2.00 Dog Park. 2.30 In Limbo. 3.00 Would I Lie To You? 3.30 Anh's Brush With Fame. 4.00 Love Your Garden. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.35 All Creatures Great And Small Christmas Special. Final. 8.35 Art Detectives. Final. 9.20 Hard Quiz. 9.50 The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. 10.20 Dog Park. 10.50 ABC Late News. 11.10 Smother. 12.00 Late Programs.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 Escape To The Country. 2.00 Home In WA. 2.30 Sydney Weekender. 3.00 Room For Improvement. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Wildlife ER. 8.30 Escape To The Country. 11.30 Late Programs.

Entertains

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.15 Whose Line Is It Anyway? 2.40 ER. 3.25 Heartbreak High. 4.10 MythBusters. 5.00 Car S.O.S. 5.45 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 MOVIE: V For Vendetta. (2005) 10.40 Late Programs.

7

6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 MOVIE: One Of A Kind Love. (2021) Jocelyn Hudon, Jake Manley. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6:30. 7.00 Better Homes And Gardens Summer. 8.30 MOVIE: Pretty Woman. (1990) 11.05 To Be Advised. 12.50 Dare Me. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 Million Dollar Minute. 5.00 Dr Harry's Animal Encounters.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.00 NFL. Awards show. 3.00 Timbersports. 3.30 Tougher In Alaska. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.30 Road Wars. 8.30 MOVIE: The Longest Yard. (2005) Adam Sandler, Chris Rock. 10.50 NFL Tailgate. 11.20 MOVIE: Major League. (1989) 1.35 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Gardening Australia Junior. 7.40 Star Wars: Young Jedi Adventures. 8.05 Scooby-Doo And Guess Who? 8.35 My Adventures With Superman. 8.55 Robot Wars. 9.55 TKO: Total Knock Out. 10.35 Late Programs.

9

6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Married At First Sight. 1.30 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Highlights of the Milano Cortina 2026 games. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. A preview of Milano Cortina 2026. 8.00 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Night. 12.00 Late Programs.

flixx

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 My France With Manu. 3.00 Monkeys Make You Laugh Out Loud. 4.00 Lopez Vs. Lopez. 4.30 America's Got Talent: Fantasy League. 6.35 MOVIE: Penguins Of Madagascar. (2014) 8.30 MOVIE: The Bone Collector. (1999) Denzel Washington. 11.00 MOVIE: Charlie's Angels. (2000) 1.00 Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 News. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 ABC Evening News. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 The World. 9.30 Play On. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Late Programs.

10

6.00 Ent. Tonight. 6.30 Bold. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 7.30 Farm To Fork. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.30 I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! 12.00 Farm To Fork. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 ACTA Awards 2026. 10.00 10's Late News. 11.00 10 News+. 11.30 Stephen Colbert. 12.30 Late Programs.

drama

6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Reel Action. 9.00 The Living Room. 10.00 JAG. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 A Million Little Things. 2.30 JAG. 4.30 The Living Room. 5.30 JAG. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 FBI: International. 11.15 A Million Little Things. 12.15 Home Shopping.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. 11.30 M*A*S*H. 12.00 Recipes For Love And Murder. 1.00 Poirot. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 MOVIE: Some People. (1962) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 New Tricks. 8.40 MOVIE: Lethal Weapon. (1987) Mel Gibson, Danny Glover. 10.55 The Equalizer. 11.55 Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 1.55 South America With Simon Reeve. 3.00 NITV News: Nula. 3.30 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.05 Secrets Of The Terror Whale. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Southern Cyprus: Aphrodite's Paradise. New. 9.30 Isle Of Wight: Jewel Of The South. 10.25 SBS World News Late. 10.55 Sisi. 11.50 Babylon Berlin. 1.40 Silent Road. 4.25 Bamay. 5.00 Late Programs.

comedy

6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.50 WorldWatch. 5.50 If You Are The One. 6.50 Jeopardy! 7.45 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 MOVIE: Risky Business. (1983) Tom Cruise, Rebecca De Mornay. 10.20 Adam Hills: The Last Leg. 11.10 Homeland. 1.15 Sex Before The Internet. 2.05 NHK World English News. 5.00 Al Jazeera Newshour.

TV

6.00 Rage Charts. 7.00 Weekend Breakfast. 9.00 Rage. 10.30 Rage Vault Guest Programmer. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Call The Midwife. 1.30 Art Detectives. Final. 2.15 All Creatures Great And Small Christmas Special. Final. 3.10 Extraordinary Escapes. 4.00 Human. Final. 5.00 Australian Story. 5.30 Dr Karl's How Things Work. 6.00 Kath & Kim. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Call The Midwife. 8.30 Midsomer Murders. 10.00 This England. 11.05 Rage.

two

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 4.00 Wildlife ER. 5.00 Horse Racing. Inglis Millennium Day And Caulfield Charity Family Day. 6.00 Luxury Escapes: World's Best Holidays. 6.30 Bondi Vet. Return. 7.30 The Yorkshire Vet. 8.30 Lewis. 10.30 Escape To The Country. 11.30 Late Programs.

Entertains

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.45 Documentary Now! 4.05 Would I Lie To You? 4.40 MythBusters. 5.30 Car S.O.S. 6.15 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 House Of Games. 9.00 Live At The Wireless. 10.20 Late Programs.

7

6.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Horse Racing. Inglis Millennium Day And Caulfield Charity Family Day. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 7.30 MOVIE: The Mummy. (1999) Brendan Fraser, Rachel Weisz. 10.00 MOVIE: American Made. (2017) Tom Cruise. 12.20 MOVIE: Daughter In Disguise. (2021) 2.30 Late Programs.

mate

6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. 3.00 Motor Racing. Alpine Rally of East Gippsland. 4.00 Desert Collectors. 5.00 Counting Cars. 6.00 Pawn Stars. 7.00 Storage Wars. 7.30 MOVIE: Ghostbusters: Afterlife. (2021) 10.00 MOVIE: In The Line Of Fire. (1993) 12.40 Late Programs.

Family

6.00 Kids' Programs. 6.05 PJ Masks Power Heroes. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.50 Andy And The Band. 7.05 Piripenguins. 7.30 Hard Quiz Kids. 8.00 Chopped Junior. 8.40 Shaun Tan's Tales From Outer Suburbia. 9.25 Fresh Off The Boat. 10.10 Abbott Elementary. 10.30 Merlin. 11.15 Late Programs.

9

6.00 Morning Programs. 8.30 Weekend Today. 11.30 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Highlights of the Milano Cortina 2026 games. 1.00 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026 Opening Ceremony. The Opening Ceremony of Milano Cortina 2026. Replay. 5.00 9News First At Five. 5.30 Find My Country House Australia. 6.00 9News Saturday. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 1. 12.00 Late Programs.

flixx

6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Extreme Weddings: Australia. 12.00 Blow Up. 1.00 Starstruck. 2.30 Dancing With The Stars. 4.30 Toddlers Make You Laugh Out Loud. 5.30 MOVIE: Playmobil: The Movie. (2019) 7.30 MOVIE: Maid In Manhattan. (2002) Jennifer Lopez. 9.45 MOVIE: Yesterday. (2019) Himesh Patel. 12.10 Late Programs.

NEWS

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 That Pacific Sports Show. 4.00 News. 4.30 The Whitlam Dismissal: 50 Years On. 5.00 News. 5.30 Asia News Week. 6.00 Evening News. 6.30 Aust Story. 7.00 National News. 7.30 Back Roads. 8.05 Four Corners. 9.00 Nightly News. 9.15 Foreign Correspondent. 10.00 Late Programs.

10

6.00 Tough Tested. 7.00 Reel Action. 7.30 Escape Fishing. 8.00 I Fish. 8.30 On The Fly. 9.00 4x4 Adventures. 10.00 I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! 1.00 Cook With Luke. 1.30 Frugal Foodie. 2.00 Farm To Fork. 2.30 Next Gen Dairy. New. 3.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 3.30 The Brighter Side. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 The Dog House Australia. 7.30 Love It Or List It Australia. Return. 8.40 Sort Your Life Out. 9.50 Ambulance Australia. 10.50 Matlock. 11.50 Late Programs.

drama

6.00 Home Shopping. 9.00 IFISH. 9.30 On The Fly. 10.30 JAG. 4.30 Soccer. A-League Men. Round 16. Brisbane Roar v Central Coast Mariners. 7.00 Football Tonight. 7.35 Soccer. A-League Men. Round 16. Western Sydney Wanderers v Melbourne City. 10.00 NCIS. 12.45 NCIS: Origins. 1.45 Home Shopping.

Gem

6.00 Morning Programs. 1.35 MOVIE: Hell Is A City. (1960) 3.25 MOVIE: Train Of Events. (1949) 5.20 MOVIE: Piccadilly Incident. (1946) 7.30 Death In Paradise. 8.40 MOVIE: Rambo: First Blood. (1982) Sylvester Stallone, Richard Crenna. 10.35 MOVIE: The Driver. (1978) 12.25 Late Programs.

SBS

6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 Figure Skating. ISU Four Continents C'ships. H'lights. 4.00 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 4.30 Cycling. Cadel Evans Great Ocean Road Race. Elite Women's. 5.30 Imperial Crown: The Myth, Mystery And Majesty. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Secrets Of Britain's Historic Houses. 8.40 Swiss Alpine Rail Journeys. 9.35 The Secret DNA Of Us. 10.40 Lord Lucan. 11.45 Outlander. 2.30 Beyond Signs. 4.25 Bamay. 5.15 Euronews. 5.30 Late Programs.

comedy

6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 7.00 The Bold And The Beautiful. 9.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.00 Frasier. 11.00 Farm To Fork. 11.30 Deal Or No Deal. 12.00 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 2.00 Friends. 6.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 The Neighborhood. 12.00 South Park. 1.00 Home Shopping. 1.30 Late Programs.

VICELAND

6.00 Morning Programs. 3.05 Heroines. 3.45 WorldWatch. 5.45 Mastermind Australia. 6.45 The Food That Built The World. Return. 7.35 Engineering From Above. 8.30 Icons Unearthed: The Simpsons. 10.20 Marcella. 12.10 WWE Legends. 1.40 Dark Side Of The '90s. 2.30 NHK World English News. 5.00 Al Jazeera Newshour.

5x5 No. 377

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

S		A		M
	H		T	
R		T		R
	T		N	
P		S		S

Edgeword No. 229

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

UG

ED

SE

OW

ON

GO

RV

DR

There may be more than one possible answer.

Crossmath No. 227

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

	×		+		=	39
-		+		-		
	×		÷		=	8
+		+		×		
	×		+		=	31
=		=		=		
9		11		2		

Solutions

EDGEWORD

S	E	S	O	P
N	O	T	A	V
R	O	R		
E	H	T		
M	A	S		S

5X5

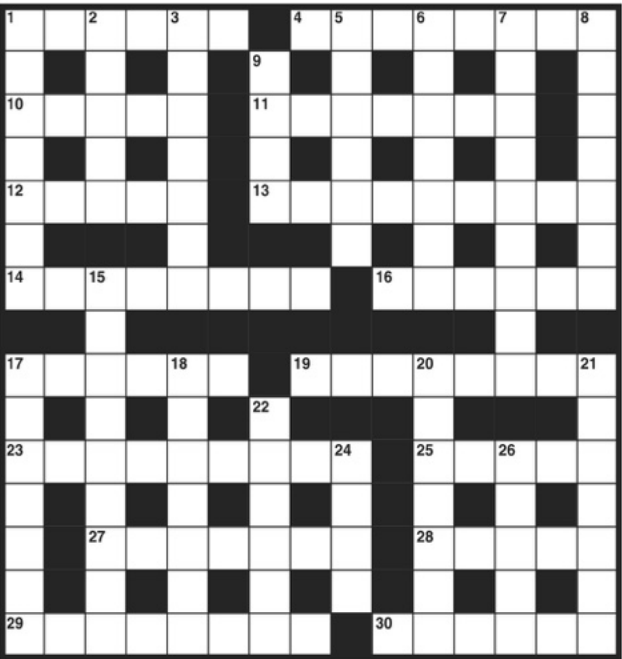
	2		11		6	
=		=		=		
13	=	7	+	3	×	8
		×		+		+
8	=	1	÷	2	×	4
		-		+		-
63	=	6	+	9	×	5

HTVWSSORC

06-02-26 | PUZZLES AND PAGINATION © pagemasters.

10 THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**

1 Church officer (6)

4 Wages (8)

10 Poem (5)

11 Criticism (7)

12 Impeached US president (5)

13 Teachers (9)
- 14 Darling (8)

16 Excellent (coll) (6)

17 Astronomical cloud (6)

19 Female server (8)

23 With healing properties (9)

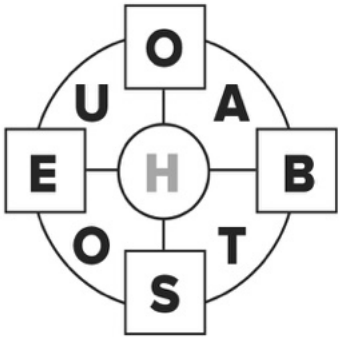
25 In addition (5)

27 Launched weapon (7)

9-LETTER

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
- 20 words: Good
- 30 words: Very good
- 41 words: Excellent



- 28 Luxury (5)
- 29 Box (8)
- 30 Finish (6)
- DOWN**
- 1 Vast Sudanese grasslands (7)
- 2 Copy (5)
- 3 South-West Pacific region (7)
- 5 Metal body protection (6)
- 6 Mean (7)
- 7 Present to someone new (9)
- 8 Meet requirements (7)
- 9 Land measure (imp) (4)
- 15 Independent official who investigates citizens' complaints (9)
- 17 Wandering from place to place (7)
- 18 Destructive insects (7)
- 20 Surgery chamber (7)
- 21 Break into pieces (7)
- 22 Motor (6)
- 24 Untruths (4)
- 26 Short melody (5)

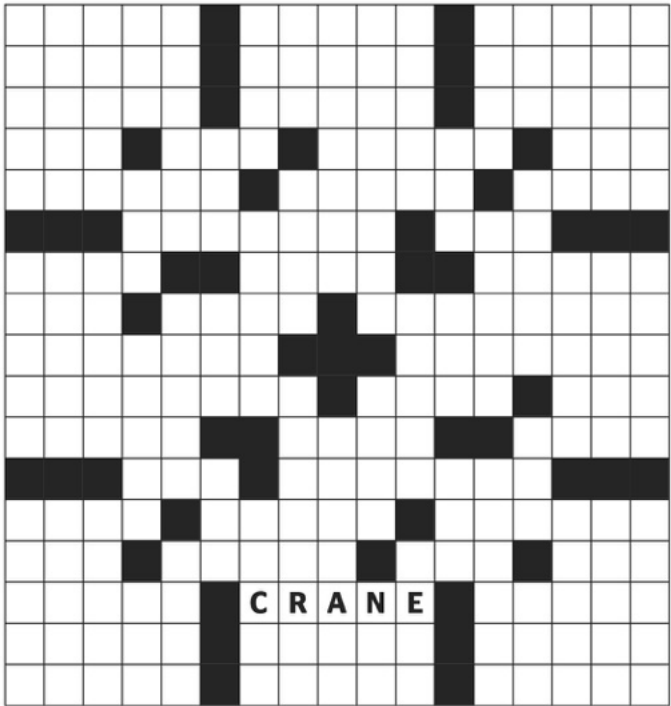


bash, bath, bathe, bathes, bathos, baths, BOATHOUSE, booth, bosh, both, bush, ethos, haste, hate, hates, haute, heat, heats, hobo, hoer, hoet, hoots, hose, host, house, HOUSEBOAT, oath, shea, shoat, shoe, shoo, shoot, shot, shout, shut, sooth, soothe, south, those, thou, thus

WORDFIT

- 3 LETTERS**
- ALL
- ARE
- AVO
- IMP
- INN
- INS
- IRE
- ITS
- NAP
- NEE
- ORE
- OWL
- PEA
- PEN
- PIE
- PIS
- PRO
- RED
- RUN
- SAC
- TEE
- UGH
- UPS
- WEE
- 5 LETTERS**
- ABORT
- ALLOT
- AMISS
- APART
- ARENA
- ASIDE
- AVAIL
- BACKS
- CASTE
- COLIC
- CRANE
- DRAWN
- DRIPS
- EDGED
- EERIE
- ENTRY
- ERASE
- FAUNA
- FETID
- GAMUT
- GEARS
- GENIE
- GLARE
- HANDY
- HASTE
- HEDGE
- KORAN
- LURED
- MARIA

- 4 LETTERS**
- CAMP
- EARL
- GEED
- KISS
- KNIT
- OWNS
- PAST
- RAGS
- SAGS
- 6 LETTERS**
- NEEDLE
- PSEUDO
- REHASH
- RESIDE



- MEATS

PLEAS

PRISM

RAFTS

SCARF

SEWER

SHARP

SIREN

SLEET

STAIR

STEER

STEPS

SWEPT

TAMES
- TEENS

TIRES

USING

WAFTS

WHENS

WHIRR

YOURE
- 7 LETTERS**

FLASHER

LEAFIER

MAIMING

MONGREL

RINSING

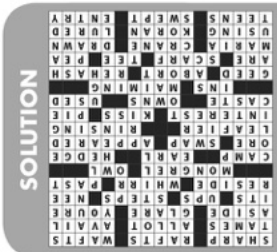
WARFARE
- 8 LETTERS**

APPEARED

INTEREST

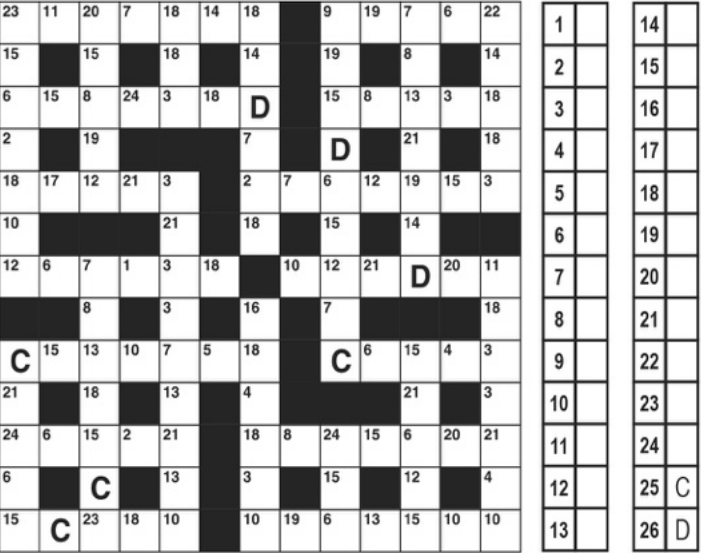
TOMORROW

TORTILLA



CODEWORD

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?



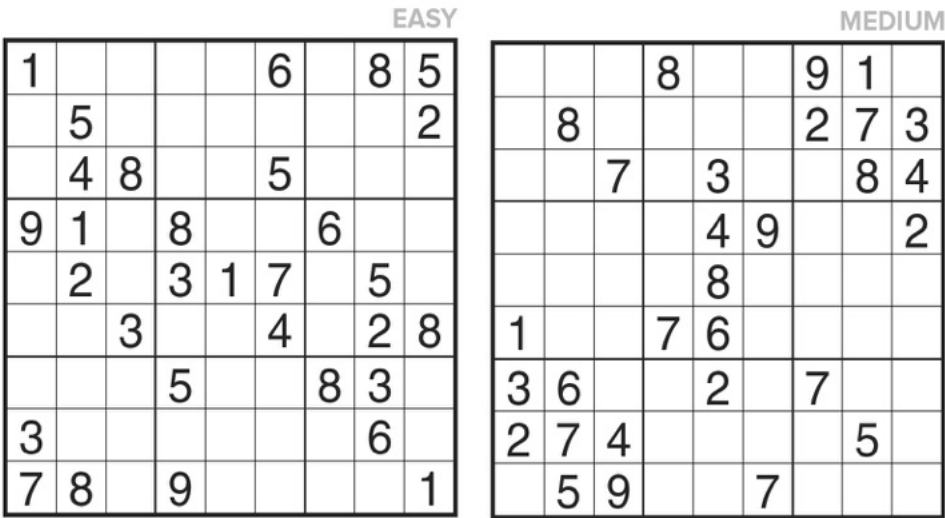
14=N, 15=A, 16=J, 17=X, 18=E, 19=U, 20=G, 21=O, 22=K, 23=H, 24=B, 25=C, 26=D

No. 112

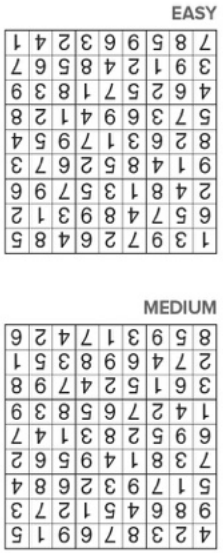
SUDOKU

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.

No. 162



SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

1. Who played Jeannie in *I Dream of Jeannie*?

2. The Little Big Town song *Better Man*, which won song of the year at the 2017 CMA Awards, was written by which pop star?

3. George Herman Ruth was most commonly known by which nickname?

4. What was the original name for London?

5. What colour is hex code #ff0000?
6. Who directed *It's a Wonderful Life*?

7. Which 1990 neo-noir film starred Gary Oldman, Sean Penn and Robin Wright (pictured)?

8. On which date is the autumnal equinox in the Northern Hemisphere?

9. To whom was Ethel Skakel married to from 1950 until his death in 1968?

10. What are the three fire signs of the zodiac?



WORD SEARCH

No. 072

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ADVENTURE

AUSTRAL

BOUNTIFUL

BREACH

BREATH TAKING

CHARTER

COLD

CONSERVATION

CRAGGY

EXPEDITION

FLOCKS

FRAGILE

FRIGID

HABITAT

HARSH

ICE CAP
- ICEBERG

JOURNEY

MASS

MELTING

MINERALS

MINKE

PASSAGE

POLE

RESEARCH

SEALS

SEAWARD

SHIP

SOUTH PACIFIC

WHALES

WIND

ANSWERS: 1. Barbara Eden 2. Taylor Swift 3. Babe 4. Londinium 5. Red 6. Frank Capra 7. State of Grace 8. September 22 9. Robert F Kennedy 10. Aries, Leo and Sagittarius

SECRET MESSAGE: An icy kingdom ruled by penguins

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Wellington & District
LEADER





AGRI TOPICS

Information for the
Man on the Land

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FORTUNATELY, I missed a lot of the extreme heat last week as Carolyn and I had six days in Sydney.

We stayed in the heart of Sydney doing day trips one catching the light rail to Circular Quay and ferry to Watsons Bay for lunch at Doyles, another day caught the Metro from Barangaroo to North Sydney and return (the metro is the new driverless train deep down in the bowels of the city and goes under the harbour.

The stations have glass panels at the edge of the platform and tracks Yet another trip was on the ferry from Barangaroo to Olympic Park and return while Carolyn with my daughters went to theatre Royal to watch “Pretty Woman” live.

Whilst another trip was to the new fish markets which are magnificent. I pigged out on half a lobster and prawns for \$35. Johanna and Carolyn had snapper and prawns with chips. I couldn’t believe the crowd there for lunch.

The final dinner was in Chinatown. It was great to catch up with my Sydney siblings.

Travelling home on the XPT I was shocked to see how dry it was from Lithgow to Wellington. Pad-docks of slender thistle, blackberry, cotton bush with little dry feed very few sheep but a lot of black cattle. In fact, Wellington looked the best only because it had more dry feed.

There is big demand for hay, I now know why. There is a lot of secondary feeding with grain, but no urea blocks why?

Grain markets

Concerns about extreme cold weather and dryness in parts of Argentina. Russian wheat exports quotes rose to a two-month high. There is solid interest for higher protein wheat out of Eastern Australia with much of WA crops having lower protein. Demand for grain for winter feed will rise as half of Eastern Australia is in drought

Markets at a glance

WOOL.. Market retreated under currency influence, 43,582 bales offered, 40,392 sold. 19 and 20 micron rose 33c with 18 up 1c ,18.5 and 19.5micron dropping 1c, Merino cardings rose 6c Xb 30m down 3c, 32m up 1c. Northern EMI 1707c/kg clean, up 5c. 6% passed in.

CATTLE.. CTLX 27th. 2142, down 1410.

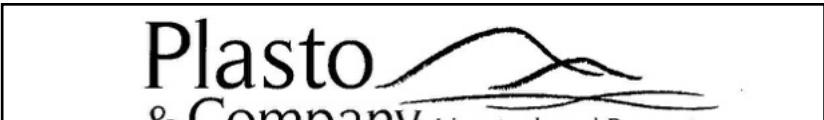
Mostly lightweight, limited supplies heavy prime and cows. Young cattle to trade firm to 10c dearer. Yearling steers 320c to 456c, heifers 350c to 460c/kg. Feeder steers steady, 380c to 486c, heifers back 10c, 371c to 420c/kg. Grown steers lifted 10c, 400c to 459c, heifers firm, 355c to 453c/kg. Cows 15c cheaper, 2 and 3 scores 220c to 380c, heavy cows 375c to 387c/kg. Heavy bulls to 397c/kg

SHEEP..-CTLX 28th. 3249 sheep (-2106) lambs 5013 (423) Quality improved with good numbers of trade and restocker lightweight secondary lambs. Lightweight processing lambs to 18kg lifted \$15, \$131 to \$212. Trade 20kg to 24kg \$8 dearer, \$230 to \$260. Heavy over 24kg \$6 better, \$242 to \$310, carcase ave 1050 and 1100c/kg cwt. Light lambs to restockers to \$248, heavy hoggets to \$240.

Mutton prices were up to \$20 dearer. Merino ewes \$94 to \$282. XB ewes \$141 to \$264. Merino wethers \$189 to \$240. Most sheep in range of 830c to 860c/kg cwt.

Don’t forget GRDC grains Update in Dubbo February 26 and 27 registrations email subscribers@grdc.com.au

STOCK CLEARANCE Seeds, fertiliser all types, poly pipe and much much more all to clear.



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property
Pty Limited

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 3800, down 4000. Very hot conditions affected numbers. Large percentage of cows with weaner calves. Some good runs of heavy cows, and well-finished grown steers and heifers. Young trade cattle up to 20c dearer, vealers and yearlings 370c to 478c/kg. Feeder steers 10c to 20c cheaper, heifers firm to 5c/kg dearer. Feeder steers 396c to 503c, heifers 384c to 438c/kg. Young restocker and backgrounder cattle firm, steers to 521c, heifers to 439c/kg. Grown steers and heifers were 13c to 20c dearer with better quality available a factor. Grown steers, 394c to 458c, heifers 378c to 439c/kg. Secondary cows 10c dearer, heavy weights 2c/kg dearer. 2 and 3 score cows to the processors 250c to 378c, heavy weights 368c to 397c, ave 382c/kg.

DUBBO LAMB.. 21,000. Fair numbers of good trade lambs, some excellent well finished heavies. Good percentage were secondary lambs showing effects of hot dry conditions. Light lambs to processors \$8 dearer, 12kg to 18kg 2-scores \$90 to \$210. Trade lambs \$5 to \$8 dearer, 20kg to 24kg \$210 to \$278, ave 1050c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$12 dearer, over 24kg \$228 to \$386, ave 1065c/kg cwt. Merino lambs \$15 dearer, trade weight Merinos \$163 to \$230, heavy Merino lambs to \$265. Heavy Dohnes \$281 to \$332. Restocker lambs dearer, better types \$146 to \$226. Hoggets to \$278.

MUTTON.. All weights and grades represented in plainer quality yarding of 17,500. Solid market, most grades at \$10 to \$15 dearer. Merino ewes \$90 to \$270, crossbred ewes \$120 to \$272. White Dorper ewes to \$285, Merino wethers \$105 to \$230. Most sheep ranged from 740c and 830c/kg cwt.

WOOL.. Another 40,000 plus bale offering last week with extremely positive price signals seen over the previous fortnight drawing held stock onto the market. The sale first day opened into the head winds of a rapidly appreciating Australian dollar against the US. Climbing above 70-cents for the first time in almost three years on the back of Tuesdays inflation data. This was a 4% increase in exchange rates compared to prior weeks’ closing wool sales. Prices re-treated upon opening for most types with the EMI falling 1.5% for the day. The positive news is that demand held firm and remained strong with the EMI actually climbing 2.5% when looked at in US dollars. A firming tone late on the first day carried over to Thursday with prices regaining some of Wednesday’s losses despite the Australian dollar strengthening further. The weekly result was a 24-cent downward movement in the EMI and a 40-cent gain when looked at in US dollars. 40,987 bales sold with 6% passed-in. Major buyers included Techwool, PJ Morris and Tianyu. Another 40,000 bale national offering is expected this week.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending January 30, 2026

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$30/25	This Week M30/25	Last Sale \$29/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2302	2268	2250	+52	1716	+586
18	2202	2194	2167	+35	1567	+635
19	2098	2084	2071	+27	1465	+633
20	2029n	2037	1998n	+31	1418n	+611
21	-	1998n	-	-	-	-
26	855n	854	-	-	-	-
28	728n	728	690n	+38	410n	+318
MC	859n	856n	848n	+11	723n	+136

Not As Bad As It Looks

AFTER TWO very strong opening weeks, one could say we were expecting a “correction.” What we were not expecting was an appreciation of the AU\$ of over 3% in such a short space of time earlier last week. The combination of a weakening USD and expectations of an interest rate hike here by the Reserve Bank next Tuesday saw the Aussie dollar climb to its highest rate against the greenback in over three years. Year on year our dollar has risen by 5.22% and the majority of that was just that week! Whilst the EMI closed 24 cents cheaper it was 40 cents dearer in US currency, so there was some surprise among exporters that the falls on Wednesday weren’t worse. The market on Thursday levelled out early and gradually regained some lost ground, particularly 18 microns and coarser and pieces. Higher VM types made significant gains on the previous day. Techwool and Endeavour were very dominant purchasing 35% of the last days offering which we think underlines the growing confidence among

exporters and processors. One shouldn’t get too concerned about the weekly changes as it’s the far-right column that makes for good reading with all Merino fleece price guides over 500 cents above this time last year. The exporters we spoke were still brimming with confidence and asking questions about supply going forward. This week will be the fourth consecutive week of over 40,000 bales and some are sceptical that production is as bad as reported. We think the remainder of the selling season will see supply tighten up as the dry conditions in areas where supply comes from in the post Easter period will be well down on last year. The offering last week of 43,500 bales saw only 6% passed-in and a gross average of \$1900 a bale. The combined Macwool/Carmichael catalogue cleared 2013 bales at a healthy \$1923 per bale average across all types. This week 40,480 bales will be offered in three centres with only one more week of selling until the new Chinese New Year recess week.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Dubbo

JACOB STIFF who began race riding in August last year is making a big impression and his momentum was further boosted with a winning treble on Monday at Dubbo.

Reared at Ballimore, outside Dubbo, Jacob Stiff is apprenticed to Michael Mulholland who supplied two of the three winners Vicious Rumour and Wing Nut while Black Nature, the other leg of the treble, is trained by Dar Lunn.

Overdue for a win after six placings from 10 starts, Vicious Rumour (\$1.70 to \$1.60 favourite) led in the straight and fought off the challenge by The Cotractor (Clayton Gallagher, \$5.50) to win by a long neck with Nightwalker (Heavelon Van Der Hoven, \$10) over three lengths away third in the 1200 metres Transforce Logistics Maiden Handicap.

Consistent and race fit, Wing Nut (\$9.50) kept coming in the straight in the 1300m Marty Nelson Refrigeration & Airconditioning Benchmark 58 Handicap to wear down Spring Prospect (Clayton Gallagher, \$1.75 fav) with St Roy (Leeshelle Small, \$201) battling on well for third.

A last-start winner at Dubbo for Dar Lunn and Jacob Stiff, Black Nature backed up to win the 1300m Lawd-Mark Medford Property Sales BM 58 Handicap.

Getting home strongly from back in the field, Black Nature (\$5) edged out another backmarker Billabong Rose (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$6.50) by a short head with Glowing Rapids (Zoe Hunt, \$4.60) a game third.

Making an auspicious return to racing after a spell, the lightly raced Western Warrior was impressive when winning the 1000m Flair Finance -BM 58 Handicap for Dubbo trainer Natalie Pearce.

Desirous held a narrow lead inside the final 200 metres however Western Warrior ((\$6.50) under strong riding from Ken Dunbar finished best to beat Desrious (Clayton Gallagher, \$5) and Denman Force (Jake Pracey-Homes, \$12).

Dubbo jockey Ken Dunbar and Gilgandra trainer Ashley Gibson who combined last week to win with Alpine Rose at Parkes were back in the winner’s circle at Dubbo with Baron Of Butter in the 1000m Soul Food Design Depot & Gallery Maiden Plate.

With a determined run from midfield, Baron Of Butter (\$3.20 to \$2.60 fav) arrived in time to gain a four-way photo-finish decision over Fortians (Clayton Gallagher, \$12), Allusive Intent (Kody Nestor, \$15) and the leader Busted Buttons (Wendy Peel, \$6).

Dubbo based apprentice Izzy Neale rode her 50th winner last week and she maintained the good form when urging the Damien Lane, Wyong trained Maximum Ride (\$4.80) through a gap to win the 1400m Aquawest Maiden Plate from Castro (Heavalon Van Der Hoven, \$4) and Arwa Miss (Ken Dunbar, \$201).

Racing at Gilgandra (Tooraweenah Cup) on Saturday and Bathurst on Monday.



WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

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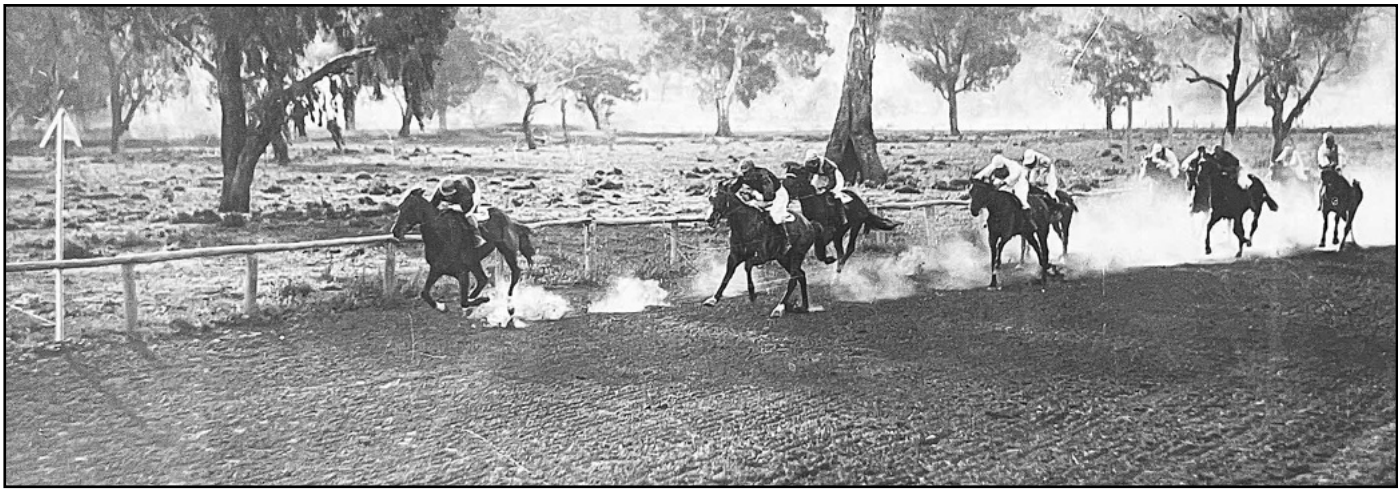
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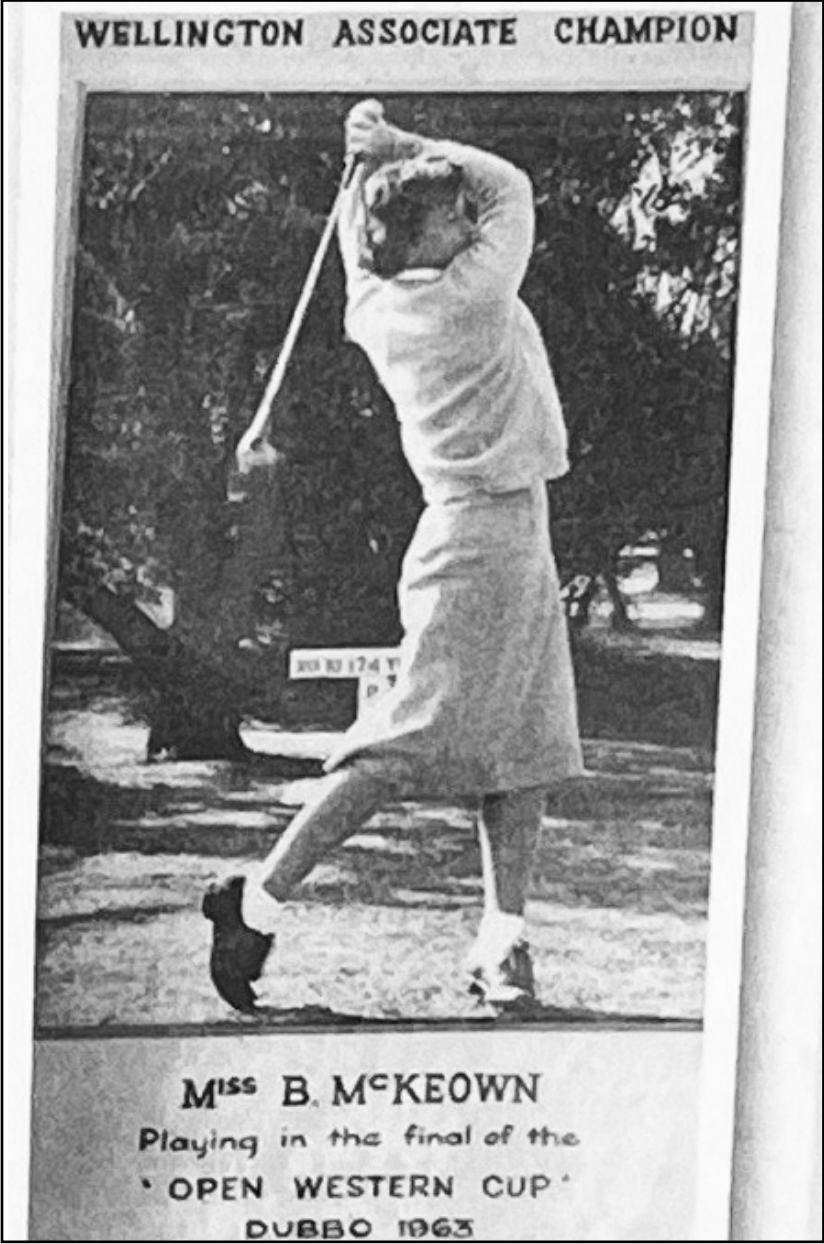
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Looking back over a century of Wellington Golf Club

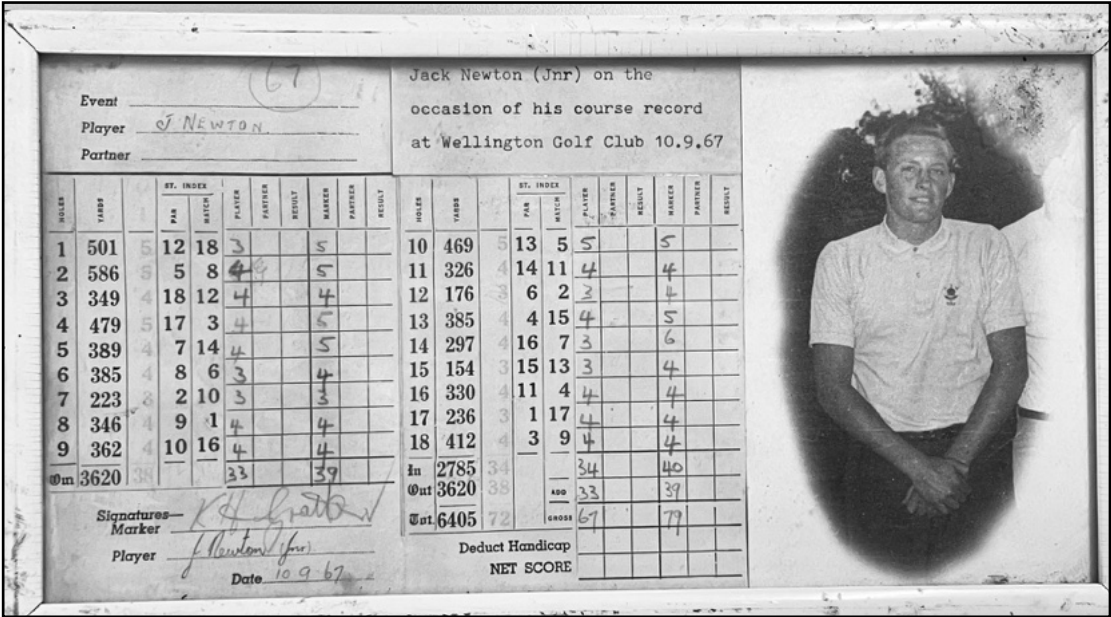
Inaugural Wellington Golf Club presidents were Dr G. B. Wade and Murdoch McLeod. In 1925 M.C. Cameron took over as president and held the office until 1950. In about 1924 a club house was built at the 'Nanima' course. The present course, referred to as the 'Caves Course', was established in 1942 with the aide of the Shire Council, having originated in 1938 as a social course located on the Bell River flats. The Nanima clubhouse was moved to the new site and in about 1947 a second 9 holes, designed by Arthur Eastand incorporating sand greens, were added. However, the disastrous 1950 floods caused the majority of the greens to be relocated on higher ground, out of flood danger. The Club's outstanding players have been Paul Kelly and Miss Betty McKeown, winners of the Club Championship on many occasions.



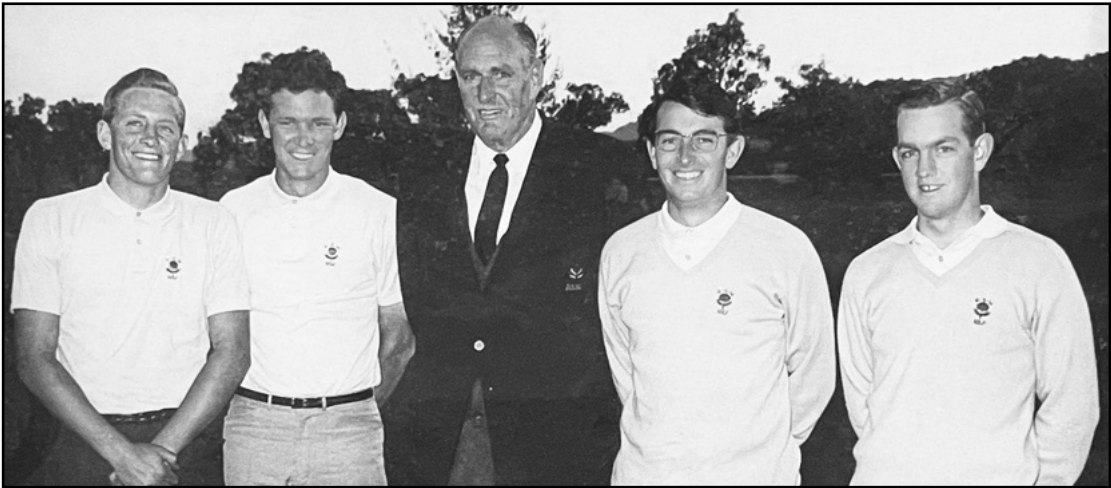
Before Wellington Golf Club moved locations from 'Namima' to the 'Caves Course' in 1942, the immediate area was a racecourse and the tree in background still stands. Check it out when out at the club for the Centenary on March 15. This race on May 16, 1928 was won by Mr B. Veech Senr's brown gelding 'Rubelin'.



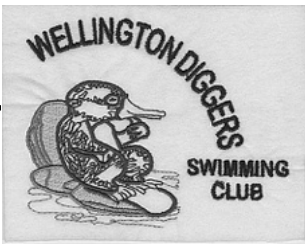
The late Betty McKeown was unbeatable when in form and a stick in her hands.



Jack Newton's card when he set his course record on September 10, 1967.



Visit by NSW State Junior team on September 10, 1967 Jack Newton Jnr, John Middlebury, team manager F. Elrington, Peter Bennett and Steven Brown.



Wellington Diggers Swimming Club News

FIFTEEN MEMBERS and two visitors participated in our weekly swim on Tuesday, January 27.

Terry Dray won the 25-metre event being 0.14 outside his time. Nick Knowles was second with Janelle Frappell third.

Nick Knowles won the 50-metre swim being 0.03 outside his time. Shane Lousick was second with Terry Dray third.

Darcy Lousick and Rhylee Hill won the junior events while Katharine O'Rourke and Olivia Willcockson won the Brace Relay being 2.12 outside their time.

Ten Members will be participating in the Western District

Championships in Cobar this Sunday, February 8.

Results for Tuesday, January 27.

Juniors

25 Metre: 1 Darcy Lousick 0.13+; 2 Nathaniel Willcockson 2.16; 3 Olivia Willcockson 2.50.

50 Metre: 1 Rhylee Hill 0.47-; 2 Olivia Willcockson 0.62-; 3 Nathaniel Willcockson 1.75+.

Seniors

25 Metre: 1 Terry Dray 0.14-; 2 Nick Knowles 0.17-; 3 Janelle Frappell 0.32-.

50 Metre: 1 Nick Knowles 0.03+; 2 Shane Lousick 0.13+; 3 Terry Dray 0.44-.

Brace Relay: 1 Katharine O'Rourke & Olivia Willcockson 2.12+; 2 Henry & Nathaniel Willcockson 2.84-; 3 Rhylee Hill & Nick Knowles 8.32.

The Platypus



Janelle's Soaps do it again at Tasmanian competition

YEAR AFTER year Janelle Frappell continues her success at the annual Artisan Goats Milk Soap Competition, this year judged by Kay Simons and Fleur Barnett.

Janelle exhibited the best exhibit with her Lemon Myrtle Goats Milk soap which had earlier won the Botanicals class.

In the Natural unscented class

Janelle was awarded first and second prizes with her Goats Milk Castile and Plain Jane respectively. In the scented class, her Black Rasbery Vanilla soap was place first while her Lavender Goats Milk was awarded second prize.

You can find her and her soaps and succulents at several Markets or on line and facebook.

Qantas due to shutdown Wagga Wagga and Albury to Melbourne routes

LOCAL Federal Member for Farrer and State member for Riverina, said they were deeply disappointed with Qantas' announcement to suspend its services from Wagga Wagga to Melbourne and Albury to Melbourne from March this year.

"We will be jointly writing to Qantas to express our concern about the axing of these routes, which will certainly have a detrimental impact on Wagga Wagga, Albury and the wider region we represent," a combined announcement said.

"This announcement is a clear reflection of the worsening economic conditions being felt by industries and households across the nation and particularly in the Riverina and Farrer electorates,

with many people conducting their business virtually due to ever-tightening margins.

"Those who are travelling for recreational and health reasons are choosing cheaper options.

"Our understanding is Qantas's Wagga Wagga to Melbourne route was unsustainably operating with less than 50 per cent of its passenger capacity and the Albury to Melbourne route was operating with less than 40pc of its passenger capacity.

"We have been assured that demand is strong for the Wagga Wagga to Sydney, Wagga Wagga to Brisbane, Albury to Sydney and Albury to Brisbane services and there is no indication these routes will be adversely affected by Qantas's announcement."

Tour de OROC 2025 smashes fundraising record

MACQUARIE HOME Stay has again benefited from funds raised by the annual Tour de OROC 2025 which tallied \$336,000.

For six days and 800 kilometres bicycle ride through Western NSW, turning grit and goodwill into life-changing support.

A huge \$100,000 was raised before the first pedal stroke thanks to a Bourkebased online auction and radiothon driven by The Bourke Rotary Club, Bourke Shire Council, 2WEB and Rotary Dubbo South.

Riders experienced some of the region's most iconic places — the Macquarie Marshes and Burrima boardwalk, The WAM (Warren's new museum), the Jandra paddle steamer at Bourke, and the ancient Brewarrina fish traps.

The route was a reminder of why this region rallies so strongly behind the cause.

Guest riders who lifted the peloton included former world champion track cyclist Megan Dunn and veteran cycling journalist and sports commentator Mike Tomolaris.

The Tour de OROC is about communities

backing communities.

This year's support was extraordinary and will make a real difference for families who need Macquarie Home Stay.

Tour de OROC chairman Ben O'Brien and Rotary Club of Dubbo South president Karen James presented the funds to Macquarie Home Stay president Andy Single and managing director Rod Crowfoot on Tuesday.

Launched in 2013, the Tour de OROC is a six-day, 800plus kilometre charity ride across the Orana Region.

Since Macquarie Home Stay opened in 2019, the Tour and the Rotary Club of Dubbo South has contributed more than \$1 million to its growth.

Macquarie Home Stay provides affordable accommodation for people from regional and remote communities travelling to Dubbo for medical treatment.

Its Stage 3 expansion will deliver new family focused accommodation to support even more visitors.

Union access to customer data unnecessary

THE STATE Government is being called upon to immediately pull its Bill that will allow Unions access to customer data, intellectual property and commercially sensitive information from small businesses across NSW.

Shadow spokesman for Small Business Gurmeh Singh said if workplace laws were being broken, there are already regulators, courts, and proper legal processes to deal with it.

"This unprecedented power grab will turn Unions into de facto police – allowing them to roam through private computer systems, acting as judge, jury and executioner," Mr Singh said.

"This government-backed proposal opens the door to serious privacy breaches, intimidation, and union bullying, especially for smaller family-run businesses.

"Every small business owner in NSW should be alarmed by this outrageous overreach."

Shadow spokesman for Work Health and Safety Tim James said this is the most interventionist digital workplace law in the country, rushed through without consultation and riddled with privacy and cybersecurity risks.

"It hands unions sweeping access to businesses' digital systems and commercially sensitive data, while crushing small businesses under

an impossible compliance burden," Mr James said.

"Abandoning nationally harmonised WHS laws and replacing certainty with regulatory chaos will stifle innovation and cost jobs.

"All of this is without clear justification, when existing WHS laws already address psychosocial risks.

"The Minns Government must abandon this extraordinary attack on innovation and jobs and ensure the data of NSW residents remains protected."

Industry Groups including the Australian Chamber of Commerce and Industry, Business NSW, Australian Industry Group, Business Council of Australia, and the Council of Small Business Organisations Australia wrote to Minister Cotsis in November last year, raising their 'significant concerns' with the Bill.

Mr Singh said the Minister's inability to explain why we need these changes is further proof she has prioritised Union demands over industry stakeholders.

"The Minister is confirming what we have always suspected - her loyalty lies with Union bosses - not with the small businesses that employ millions of Australians and keep regional communities alive."

Your sport can record results in the

“Sport” section.

Just contact: mark@wdleader.news

In Their Sights

Fashions Mount Rifle Club

Results from Saturday, January 31.

Hunting Class: R. Dowton 96.9, L. Hough 96.9, G. Wilson 75, D. Gollan 36, W. Grant 25.

600 Yards: L. Hough 110.6, S. King 109, P Spedding 97, B. Spedding 89, R. Dowton 85.1.

Next Shoot Saturday, February 7 at 500 yards

The Rifleman

Junior Touch - Alysha Spradbrow Photos

Wellington Juniors shine at Peter Wilson Memorial Cup

WELLINGTON JUNIORS Under 10, Under 12 and Under 14 representative touch football teams travelled to Nelson Bay over the weekend to compete at the Peter Wilson Memorial Cup, producing a strong showing against quality opposition.

The Under 10s enjoyed an outstanding tournament, narrowly missing a semi-final appearance by just one try in a hard-fought quarter-final clash against Dubbo.

The team displayed great determination and composure, matching it with some of the strongest sides in the competition.

Wellington's Under 12s also impressed, just falling short of a semi-final berth.

In a highlight performance, the side crossed for three tries against a team that had conceded only two tries throughout the round games, showcasing their attacking ability and resilience under pressure.

The Under 14s started the carnival strongly and showed exceptional teamwork throughout the weekend.

Battling through the tournament with only three substitutes, the group held together admirably and finished their campaign on a high, recording a well-deserved win in

their final match.

Wellington Touch would like to extend its thanks to the referees and tournament officials for their dedication across the weekend, as well as the local sponsors and supporters whose continued backing makes representative opportunities like this possible for our young athletes.

Across all age groups, Wellington players demonstrated commitment, teamwork and sportsmanship, making the Peter Wilson Memorial Cup a valuable and positive experience for the region's young athletes.

Alysha Spradbrow



Wellington U12s Cricket - Jo Ivey Photos

Wellington
Mixed 12s
played
Dubbo
CYMS
Cougars 12A
at Pioneer
Park



Swim Pointscore - Carmen Gain Photos

Strong performances at Speedo Sprint heats in Dubbo

SEVEN LOCAL swimmers competed in challenging conditions at the Speedo Sprint Heats at Dubbo on Saturday evening, with temperatures soaring as athletes raced for a place at the upcoming Speedo Finals in Sydney.

The swimmers delivered a series of impressive performances, producing personal bests, podium finishes and club records throughout the meet.

Oliver Tomkins recorded massive personal best times in both his freestyle and breaststroke events, while Grace Sharp, competing in her first carnival of the season, swam beautifully and narrowly missed out on a top-four placing.

Sage Smith also delivered a strong performance, smashing her previous times and just missing qualification for the finals. Lochlan Salmon competed as an exhibition swimmer and impressed by taking time off his freestyle entry time.

Eight-year-old Elsie Gain, also swimming as an exhibition competitor, had an outstanding meet. She placed first in the butterfly,

second in freestyle, third in breaststroke and fourth in backstroke, an exceptional result for such a young swimmer.

Roman Dowton produced one of the standout performances of the evening, winning the 10 years butterfly and placing second in his remaining three events. In an extraordinary achievement, Roman broke three club records on the night, two of which he had already previously set.

Lakyn Dowton also enjoyed a highly successful meet, finishing with three first-place results and one second-place finish, all while achieving personal best times.

Roman and Lakyn have now qualified to represent Western Area Swimming at the Speedo Finals in Sydney this March.

The results reflect the dedication of both swimmers and coaching staff, highlighting a strong, competitive squad that continues to produce excellent times at a high level of competition.

Carmen Gain



Golfing News

Last round of summer comp this Saturday

Wellington’s golf course will celebrate its 100 Year anniversary on Sunday, March 15, and everyone is welcome to join club members to celebrate on the day.

Marked as a family day out, there will be plenty of activities for the youngsters while the older folk play a fun-filled four-person Ambrose.

More details to come but mark the date in your calendar for a fun-family day.

Ambros bookings close on March 8, so there’s plenty of time to make up your teams. Golfing cost will include breakfast and lunch while there will be a barbecue running for all during the day.

See the feature inside today.

Last Saturday golfers played an Individual Stableford plus Round 9 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition.

With plenty of golfers again hitting the fairways winners were again allocated in A and B grades last week.

Winner in A grade was Michael Bullock who had a great day with 44pts. Runner-up was Noel Stanford with 39pts on a countback.

Winner in B grade was Rod Irwin who put together a good round to finish with 41pts while Wally Bruce also had a good day finishing with 40pts and runner-up accolade.

Prize winners were, Gary McCarroll, Liam Conn 39pts; Jono Smith, Mathew Reid 38pts; Rod Miller, Rod McMahon, Malcolm Payne, Matt Ringland 37pts; Jamie Robertson, Cheryl Royal, Doug Ney, Allison Brien, Richard Agar, Steven McCarroll 36pts; Nathan Stewart 35pts on c/b.

Nearest the pinon the 3rd John Donnelly, 8th Garry McNaughton, 14th Rod Irwin, 16th Jono Smith. NTP in two-shots on the fourth hole went to Doug Ney.

Jespresso Cafe longest drives went to Michael Bullock in A grade and Brad Conn in B grade.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was taken out by David Drake from Yeoval; he must have left his golf game at home with a final score of 23pts.

Wednesday’s ladies day was an Individual Stableford won by Gae Drew who showed all the ladies how it’s done to finish the day with 35pts while Kathy Martin was runner-up with 32pts on c/b.

The 9-hole competition results from the past few weeks were Round 1 Kathy Martin with 35pts; Rounds 2 and 3 Jan Payne with 35pts. This competition is open to all members, and non-members are more than welcome to join in the fun.

Thursday’s Individual Stableford was won by Mathew Reid who finished with 42pts. Runner-up was Joe Ryan with 41pts.

Prize winners were James Fleming 37pts; John Gersbach, Jamie Robertson 36pts; Stephen Whiteman 35pts on c/b.

Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 9-hole results for Round 17 results are still to come.

However, the leaders after Round 17 has Tim Parker taking over the lead -10, Ashley Bullock on -9, next Adam Ryan -8, Joe and David Ryan -7.

Results for Round 9 of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Comp: Bell River Bandits defeated Soldiers Memorial Club 2up, Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws d Used Groceries 1up, Power Rangers d Snipers 3up, Maulers d Railway Boys 1up, Kevaliers d The Masters

3up, Pheonix d Dirt Diggers 5up, Lion of Waterloo drew with Dirty Birds.

Draw for this competition’s the final round: Bell River Bandits v Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws, Soldiers Memorial Club v Snipers, Used Groceries v Railway Boys, Kevaliers v Power Rangers, Maulers v Dirt Diggers, The Masters v Dirty Birds, Lion of Waterloo v Pheonix.

Points table after nine rounds has Kevaliers 43.6pts, Lion of Waterloo 36.6pts, Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws 34.2pts, Maulers 32.3pts, Bell River Bandits, Pheonix 30.6pts, Dirty Birds 30.3pts, Masters 28.3pts, Power Rangers 26.5pts, Soldiers Memorial Club 23.9pts, Used Groceries 21.6pts, Snipers 19.4pts, Dirt Diggers 19.3pts, Railway Boys 16.1pts.

Teams in the top 8 could miss the finals with a loss, and of course those near that bracket could cause some mayhem.

Finals are to be played with a top 8, bottom 4 will play an elimination game, top 4 will play a qualifying game.

This Saturday’s events are the February Monthly Medal kindly sponsored by Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club plus the Final round of the Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition plus the George Hollow Putting Competition.

19th Hole

Calling sporting club publicity officers

Get your news, results and photos to

mark@wdleader.news

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SATURDAY 14TH FEBRUARY

STARTS FROM 7.30PM

If you are aged 18 to 30 years on April 10, 2026

You are invited to enter the

2026

TOOHEYS

GUYS & DOLLS

Challenge

There are 14 places to match 14 horses eligible to run in the

2026 Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club

Wellington Boot race

to be run on Sunday, April 12.

All entries will be placed into a barrel and 14 names will be drawn during the Wellington Boot Calcutta at Wellington Soldiers Club from 7pm Saturday, April 11

Each person drawn from the barrel will then draw a horse entered for the Boot race. Bonus prizes for the first three placegetters.

Conditions of entry:-

Nominees must be at the Calcutta night and must be at the Boot Races on Sunday as guests of Tooheys, Wellington Soldiers Club, Wellington & District Leader and Wellington Race Club

Nomination Forms

at the Soldiers Club from 2nd February, 2026.

Further conditions of entry of nomination form

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LAST STAND

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PLUS

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Wellington Show

WELLINGTON Soldiers Memorial Club

Boot Weekend

A TRIBUTE TO

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STARTS FROM 7.30PM